

D394

Care for Individuals and Families

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An 80-year-old man goes home from a two-week hospital stay for pneumonia with a new discharge medication list. His daughter, a high school math teacher, brings his pill bottles from home to the first home health visit. The home has a well-kept garden and a ramp. What should the home health professional do first with the medications?

- A. Discard all the old bottles and start fresh.
- B. Have the daughter manage the pills because she is good with numbers.
- C. Compare the home bottles with the discharge list and resolve any differences with the prescriber.
- D. Follow the discharge list because it is the newest order.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient moves from the ICU to a medical floor within the same hospital. Is medication reconciliation needed?

- A. No; the same hospital means the same records.
- B. Yes; any transfer between levels of care, even within one hospital, requires reconciliation.
- C. No; reconciliation happens only at admission and discharge.
- D. Only if the patient asks for it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 52-year-old woman with prediabetes who works nights as a security guard says she wants to “get healthier.” She has a cat and lives near a park. Which goal best meets the SMART standard?

- A. Walk in the park near her home.
- B. Walk 20 minutes after her shift on five days a week for the next eight weeks.
- C. Get healthier this year.
- D. Lose 40 pounds in one month.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A nurse calls a physician about a post-op patient whose blood pressure dropped from 128/80 to 88/50 in an hour. The patient is a retired firefighter who enjoys fishing. Using SBAR, what should the nurse say first?

- A. That the patient is a retired firefighter.
- B. A request for a fluid bolus.
- C. The patient's full surgical and medical history.
- D. The current situation: the patient's blood pressure has dropped to 88/50 in the last hour.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A social worker ends a handoff call with "I think she is not safe to go home alone, so I'd like a home safety evaluation before discharge." Which SBAR element is the last clause?

- A. Recommendation
- B. Situation
- C. Assessment
- D. Background

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A 70-year-old woman is ready to leave the hospital after a hip replacement. She is medically stable but needs daily physical therapy and help with walking. She is a retired librarian with two grown sons out of state. Which setting best fits?

- A. An inpatient rehab or skilled nursing facility.
- B. Stay in the acute hospital until she walks alone.
- C. An ambulatory clinic visit next month.
- D. Home with her sons caring for her.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient can drive, lives alone, and needs a weekly blood test and dose adjustment. Which setting fits?

- A.** Skilled nursing facility.
- B.** Acute hospital.
- C.** An ambulatory clinic or outpatient lab.
- D.** Home health.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

On day one of admission, a man with a stroke is found to live alone on the third floor with no elevator. His hospital room has a view of the river. His insurer requires prior approval for rehab. When should discharge planning start?

- A.** After he can walk up three flights of stairs.
- B.** When the physician writes the discharge order.
- C.** Only if the insurer denies rehab.
- D.** Now, at admission, including the prior approval request and housing concerns.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A woman caring for her husband with heart failure at home looks tired and says she has not slept well in weeks. Her husband agreed that she should be included in his care. They have been married 45 years and have three grandchildren. What is the best action?

- A.** Tell her she must hire a nurse.
- B.** Ask the grandchildren to take over.
- C.** Focus teaching only on the husband, since he is the patient.
- D.** Include her in teaching and assess her strain and need for respite or support.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Three weeks ago, a clinic faxed a cardiology referral for a patient with new chest pain. No appointment appears in the record. The clinic recently switched fax vendors. What is the care coordinator's responsibility?

- A.** Nothing; the referral was sent.
- B.** Follow up with the patient and cardiology until the appointment is scheduled and results return.
- C.** Blame the fax vendor and resend the same fax.
- D.** Wait for the patient to call if symptoms worsen.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A patient whose family you have supported for months sends a friend request on social media and invites you to her daughter's wedding. She has been very grateful and just finished treatment. The wedding is at a lakeside resort. What is the best response?

- A.** Accept the friend request only.
- B.** Go to the wedding because the resort is nearby.
- C.** Thank her warmly and decline both, explaining your role's professional limits.
- D.** Accept both, since treatment is finished.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which action by a health professional crosses a professional boundary?

- A.** Sharing details of her own divorce with a patient during several visits.
- B.** Refusing a \$200 gift card from a patient.
- C.** Learning a patient's preferred name.
- D.** Sitting at eye level while talking.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

An 80-year-old man goes home from a two-week hospital stay for pneumonia with a new discharge medication list. ~~His daughter, a high school math teacher,~~ brings his pill bottles from home to the first home health visit. ~~The home has a well-kept garden and a ramp.~~ What should the home health professional do first with the medications?

Target word: first step at transition **Decides:** Reconcile home bottles with the discharge list.

A	Inverted operation	Removes the evidence needed to reconcile and may drop needed drugs.
B	Camouflage	Her job does not replace reconciliation.
C	Correct	Medication reconciliation at each transition catches duplications and omissions.
D	Absolute language	Assumes the discharge list is complete and correct; reconciliation checks it.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A patient moves from the ICU to a medical floor within the same hospital. Is medication reconciliation needed?

Target word: reverse: is an internal move a transition **Decides:** Any change in level of care is a transition.

A	Camouflage	Same records do not mean the orders match the new level of care.
B	Correct	ICU drips and orders often change on transfer.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out internal transfers.
D	Adjacent category	Reconciliation is a safety standard, not an optional request.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A 52-year-old woman with prediabetes who works nights as a security guard says she wants to “get healthier.” ~~She has a cat and lives near a park.~~ Which goal best meets the SMART standard?

Target word: judge the goal **Decides:** Specific, measurable, time-bound, and hers.

A	Camouflage	Uses the park detail but has no amount or time frame.
B	Correct	Specific activity, measurable amount, achievable, and time-bound.
C	Dropped element	Missing specific and measurable elements.
D	Absolute language	Not achievable or safe; an extreme target.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A nurse calls a physician about a post-op patient whose blood pressure dropped from 128/80 to 88/50 in an hour. ~~The patient is a retired firefighter who enjoys fishing.~~ Using SBAR, what should the nurse say first?

Target word: first element of SBAR **Decides:** Situation leads.

A	Camouflage	Social detail does not belong in an urgent SBAR opening.
B	Confusion set	That is the Recommendation, which comes last.
C	Inverted operation	History is Background, second, not first.
D	Correct	SBAR opens with the problem now.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A social worker ends a handoff call with “I think she is not safe to go home alone, so I’d like a home safety evaluation before discharge.” Which SBAR element is the last clause?

Target word: reverse: classify a statement **Decides:** A request for action.

A	Correct	Asking for a specific action is the R.
B	Adjacent category	Situation is the current problem.
C	Confusion set	“I think she is not safe” is the assessment; the request is the recommendation.
D	Adjacent category	Background is relevant history.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A 70-year-old woman is ready to leave the hospital after a hip replacement. She is medically stable but needs daily physical therapy and help with walking. ~~She is a retired librarian~~ with two grown sons out of state. Which setting best fits?

Target word: best next setting **Decides:** Stable, needs daily skilled therapy.

A	Correct	Daily skilled therapy after a hospital stay is what these settings provide.
B	Absolute language	She is stable; acute care is for unstable conditions.
C	Inverted operation	Too little care for her daily needs.
D	Camouflage	Her sons live out of state.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A patient can drive, lives alone, and needs a weekly blood test and dose adjustment. Which setting fits?

Target word: reverse: from setting rule to patient **Decides:** Mobile and stable.

A	Adjacent category	Overshoots his needs.
B	Absolute language	He is stable.
C	Correct	He is not homebound and needs only periodic care.
D	Confusion set	Home health requires being homebound.

8. Answer D Concept 5

On day one of admission, a man with a stroke is found to live alone on the third floor with no elevator. ~~His hospital room has a view of the river.~~ His insurer requires prior approval for rehab. When should discharge planning start?

Target word: timing of planning **Decides:** Home barriers and payer needs identified at admission.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the floor number as a trigger; the barrier should be planned for now.
B	Inverted operation	Too late; approval and housing take time.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the housing issue and delays planning.
D	Correct	Early planning avoids delays and unsafe discharges.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A woman caring for her husband with heart failure at home looks tired and says she has not slept well in weeks. Her husband agreed that she should be included in his care. ~~They have been married 45 years and have three grandchildren.~~ What is the best action?

Target word: include and assess the caregiver **Decides:** Caregiver strain signs; patient consent given.

A	Absolute language	An absolute order instead of assessing needs and options.
B	Camouflage	The grandchildren detail does not decide the action.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the caregiver who does the care.
D	Correct	The family is part of the unit of care.

10. Answer B Concept 7

Three weeks ago, a clinic faxed a cardiology referral for a patient with new chest pain. No appointment appears in the record. ~~The clinic recently switched fax vendors.~~ What is the care coordinator's responsibility?

Target word: referral follow-through **Decides:** No appointment after three weeks.

A	Inverted operation	Sending is not completing.
B	Correct	Closing the loop is the coordinator's job.
C	Camouflage	The vendor change is not the core issue; tracking is.
D	Adjacent category	Puts the burden on the patient instead of coordinating.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A patient whose family you have supported for months sends a friend request on social media and invites you to her daughter's wedding. She has been very grateful and just finished treatment. ~~The wedding is at a lakeside resort.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: boundary decision **Decides:** Dual relationship risk.

A	Dropped element	Social media connection is still a dual relationship.
B	Camouflage	Location does not decide the boundary question.
C	Correct	Maintains the therapeutic relationship.
D	Absolute language	Assumes all boundaries end when treatment ends.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

Which action by a health professional crosses a professional boundary?

Target word: reverse: identify the violation **Decides:** Shifting focus to the professional's needs.

A	Correct	Repeated personal disclosure shifts the relationship to the professional.
B	Inverted operation	Refusing is maintaining the boundary.
C	Confusion set	Person-centered care, not a boundary issue.
D	Adjacent category	Good communication, not a violation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transitions are the danger zone	Errors cluster at handoffs between settings, so medications are reconciled at every transition: compare what the patient took before, during, and after, and resolve every difference.	Assuming the discharge medication list is correct because the hospital wrote it.	A patient moving between hospital, rehab, home, or clinic.
2	SMART health goals	Goals the individual or family helps set are Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.	Accepting a vague goal like “eat better” or setting the goal for the patient.	A goal statement to judge or improve.
3	SBAR handoff communication	Situation, Background, Assessment, Recommendation — lead with the current problem, give only the history that matters, state what you think is going on, and say what you need.	Opening with the full history, or ending without a clear request.	A call or handoff to another discipline, especially an urgent one.
4	Matching the setting to the need	Acute hospital for unstable conditions; skilled nursing or rehab for daily skilled care after a stay; home health for homebound patients needing intermittent skilled care; ambulatory clinics for stable, mobile patients.	Choosing the most intensive setting to be safe, or home health for someone who can drive to a clinic.	A description of stability, skilled needs, and mobility at discharge.
5	Discharge planning starts at admission	Planning for the next setting begins on day one: identify home situation, supports, equipment, and payer needs early so discharge is not delayed or unsafe.	Waiting until the physician writes the discharge order to plan.	A newly admitted patient with obvious home or support issues.
6	The family as the unit of care	Holistic care includes the family and caregivers: with the patient’s permission, involve them in teaching, and assess caregiver capacity and strain.	Teaching only the patient, or sharing information with family without the patient’s consent.	A caregiver who will do the care at home, or signs of caregiver exhaustion.
7	Closing the loop on referrals	Care coordination means one accountable person tracks each referral until the appointment happens and results return to the team.	Treating a faxed referral as a completed referral.	A referral sent weeks ago with no follow-up.
8	Professional boundaries	The relationship exists for the patient’s benefit; avoid dual relationships, significant gifts, and personal disclosure that shifts focus to the professional.	Thinking friendliness outside work shows good rapport.	Social media requests, gifts, or meeting a patient outside the role.

Course scope (public description): Care for Individuals and Families focuses on the holistic care of individuals, families, and populations with multifaceted healthcare needs. This course improves critical thinking and

interdisciplinary communication skills to provide information to individuals or groups in a variety of settings. The focus of the course is on managing the transition of an individual, family, or group through a variety of healthcare settings, which can include acute care hospitals, extended stay facilities, ambulatory care clinics, home care, outreach, or wellness. This course helps students develop effective professional communication skills and appropriate behaviors to ensure an individual, family, or group is successful in meeting its healthcare goals. There are no prerequisites for this course.